Dino Gang

Little learning games for ages 3 to 6



A quick guide for grown-ups

dinogang.netlify.app

Works on a phone, tablet or computer. Free. No accounts, no ads. Works offline after the first visit.

Tip: add it to your Home Screen so it opens like an app (see page 5).

What's inside

Five places to play. Each one has its own pompom jar.



Word Wizards

Phonics sound cards. Autumn 1 (20 sounds) and Autumn 2 (15 sounds) are ready. Spring 1, other spellings and tricky words are coming. Press Sound to hear the pure sound ("sss", not "suh"), then the word. Choose Letter first or Word first on the Word Wizards screen: Word first starts with a picture to name.

Number Wizards

Counting to 5 and to 10, spotting each number as a coloured block pattern, and number bonds to 5 and 10. Point to each object once and count out loud.

Spanish Wizards

First Spanish (Spain): greetings, colours, numbers 1 to 10 and short phrases. A picture or a short clip, a question you hear, then the answer.

Portuguese Wizards

The same four sets in European Portuguese (Portugal).

Language Zone

Just listening, no scores. Tap a picture to hear the English word, then Spanish, Portuguese or both. Choose with the flags at the top.

How it fits school

What each part lines up with.



Phonics

Word Wizards teaches the letter sounds in a sequence based on the Department for Education's **Letters and Sounds** guidance (2007), the framework behind many school phonics programmes. It starts with the first 20 sounds, then the next 15. Sounds are said in the clipped way schools teach them, with a picture word to go with each.

Early maths

Number Wizards covers the Reception **Number** ideas: counting objects one to one, knowing that the last number says how many, recognising numerals, and seeing a number as two parts. It is not tied to one maths scheme.

Languages

Foreign languages are only required from Key Stage 2, so Spanish and Portuguese here are **early listening and fun**: hear a word, say it back, link it to a picture. Spain Spanish and Portugal Portuguese.

Learning rule

A card counts as **learned** after three "Got it" taps in a row. "Not yet" brings the card back soon. There are no wrong answers and no timers.

Ages: 3 to 4, listen and point. 5 to 6, say it. A grown-up beside the child works best.

Dino Gang is an independent home project. It is not affiliated with, or endorsed by, the Department for Education or any phonics programme or publisher.

Playing a card

One short session is ten cards.



1. **Pick a set**
   Tap a tile on the home screen.

2. **Listen**
   Press the sound button. Language cards play the question on their own.

3. **Turn over**
   Tap the card or the blue Turn over button. The answer shows, and Language cards say it.

4. **Got it or Not yet**
   Be honest. Both earn a pompom.

Pompoms

Every card finished earns a pompom, so effort is rewarded, not just right answers. Each wizard has its own pompom total at the top of the screen, and the jars on the home screen fill as cards are learned. There are no streaks, hearts or leaderboards.



Menus and settings

Where everything is.



Logo, top left	Back to the list of wizards.
Menu, top right	Switch between Word, Number, Spanish and Portuguese Wizards and the Language Zone.
Cog, top right	For grown-ups, so **press and hold for one second**. Opens the settings below.

In the settings

- **Colours:** Light (the standard), Dark, or match the device.
- **Say it aloud automatically:** plays the sound when a card turns over, and the word when a picture card appears.
- **Language questions:** a mix, "what does it mean?" (listening), or "how do you say it?" (speaking).
- **Clear progress:** tap twice. This wipes pompoms and learned cards on this device.

Good to know

- **Add to Home Screen:** iPhone, Safari, Share then Add to Home Screen. Android, Chrome menu then Install app.
- **Offline:** open it once online, then it works without internet.
- **Updates:** new versions arrive quietly. Close the app and open it again to see them. "What's new" on the home screen says what changed.
- **Private:** no accounts or tracking. Progress stays on the device, so it does not move between devices.
- **More help:** dinogang.netlify.app/about has this guide online, always up to date.